PRD: Cinematic Portfolio Website (Odd Frame Media-style)

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1. Overview

Goal: Build a premium, scroll-driven portfolio website for a creative agency / production house that matches the structure, interactions and feel of oddframemedia.com, with a real backend (CMS, contact form, email, analytics) and a production deployment.

What the reference site is (from its live page): a dark, cinematic, motion-heavy site built on Next.js (it uses the `/_next/image` pipeline) and Vercel Blob storage for uploaded media. Video is embedded from YouTube. Its tagline is "Your ODD Content Partner", and the interface uses film language everywhere: REC indicator, "Odd Archive / 01", "Cinematic Evidence", "Scroll Stoppers", "Director's Desk", "The Final Cut".

Important: Replicate the *structure, UX patterns and technical approach*, not the content. Use your own brand name, copy, logos, videos, client names and images. Copying another company's text, client logos and footage is a legal and credibility risk.

Target users: (1) brands/agencies deciding whether to hire you, (2) collaborators/vendors, (3) recruiters. Primary conversion: **submit a project brief** or **call/WhatsApp**.

2. Goals and Success Metrics

Goal	Metric / Target
Fast first impression	LCP under 2.5s on 4G mobile; Lighthouse Performance 85+ mobile
Lead generation	Brief form completion rate above 3% of unique visitors
Discoverability	All pages indexed; valid structured data; Lighthouse SEO 95+
Maintainability	Owner can add/edit projects, reels, clients and blog posts without code
Reliability	99.9% uptime; zero lost form submissions

Non-goals (v1): e-commerce, client login portal, multi-language, in-site video hosting/transcoding.

3. Site Map

Route	Purpose
`/`	Home: all major sections (see 4)
`/portfolio?format=horizontal` and `?format=vertical`	Full filterable work library (16:9 films, 9:16 reels)
`/portfolio/[slug]`	Case study page
`/reels`	Vertical reels feed
`/services` and `/services/[slug]`	Service overview and detail pages (strategy, scriptwriting, etc.)
`/about`	Our Story
`/production-ecosystem`	Partner / in-house production infrastructure
`/clients/[slug]`	Per-client page with related work
`/blog` and `/blog/[slug]`	Editorial section ("The Odd Treatment" equivalent)
`/vendor-registration`	Crew/vendor sign-up form
`/privacy-policy`, `/terms-of-service`	Legal
`/admin/*`	Private CMS dashboard
`/sitemap.xml`, `/robots.txt`	SEO

4. Frontend Requirements: Every Element

4.1 Global elements

- **Navbar:** logo, links (Work, Services, Our Story, Blog), quick links to Films and Reels, a prominent CTA button ("Step Into The Frame" → scrolls to contact), a phone link ("Coffee?" → `tel:`), and social icons (Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn).
- **Mobile menu:** full-screen overlay styled like a phone OS ("Mob_OS" in the reference), large tap targets, animated open/close.

- **REC indicator:** small blinking red dot + "REC" label, fixed in a corner and repeated in section headers and footer. Pure CSS animation.
- **Theme:** near-black background (`#050505`), high-contrast white type, one accent colour, a bold display typeface plus a clean sans for body. Film-grain overlay (optional, low opacity).
- **Custom cursor (desktop):** dot/ring that grows on video cards and links. Disabled on touch.
- **Smooth scroll:** Lenis (or similar) with reduced-motion fallback.
- **Page transitions** between routes.
- **Footer:** brand blurb, social links, Explore links, contact (city, email, phone), legal links, copyright.

4.2 Home page sections (in order)

1. **Hero:** full-bleed looping muted autoplay video background (YouTube embed or self-hosted MP4 with a poster image fallback), headline, sub-copy, two buttons ("Watch Showreel" opens a lightbox player, "Explore Portfolio" scrolls down), and a "scroll for more" cue.
2. **Cinematic Evidence (pinned scroll showcase):** a sequence of full-viewport project slides (thumbnail, brand name, title, category, counter like "Archive / 01"). Each slide pins while scrolling, then transitions to the next. Hint text: "Scroll down for more". Built with GSAP ScrollTrigger.
3. **Our Architecture (3-phase process):** Phase 01 *Concept It* (strategy, scriptwriting, campaigns, brand consulting), Phase 02 *Shoot It* (brand films, commercials, music videos, corporate, fashion/product), Phase 03 *Finish It* (editing, colour grading, motion graphics, post, BTS). Large numerals, each service linking to its detail page.
4. **On Set (BTS gallery):** infinite auto-scrolling image marquee with lazy-loaded optimised images; pause on hover.
5. **Scroll Stoppers / The Feed:** a horizontal swipe deck of 9:16 reel cards (thumbnail, brand, title). Drag/swipe on touch, arrows on desktop; tap to open the reel in a vertical player.
6. **Trusted By (logo marquee):** infinite logo strip, grayscale by default; on touch/hover it pauses and reveals colour ("Touch to pause & reveal colors").
7. **Horizontal Work Library ("Library Index"):** a list of titles on one side and a large preview on the other; selecting an item swaps the active project. Each project block shows muted autoplay preview, brand, title, description, a **credits slate** (director, DOP, editor, collaborators, special thanks) and a "View Case Study" button. Ends with "Explore Our Work".

8. **Vertical Work Library:** same pattern for 9:16 reels with "Explore Case Study" and a "View all vertical work" link.
9. **Services overview:** 3 phases with service links, plus a "Ready to brief us?" CTA to the contact section.
10. **In-house production partner:** logo, short story, link to the ecosystem page.
11. **Brands We've Framed:** grid of client logos, each linking to its client page.
12. **Blog teaser ("The Odd Treatment"):** latest article card with excerpt and read link.
13. **FAQ accordion:** grouped by tab (About, Work & Services, Budgets/Timelines), accessible expand/collapse, and FAQPage structured data.
14. **Contact: interactive project brief ("The Final Cut"):**

- Step 1: name, email, phone, company
- Project type chips (Commercial, Brand Film, Music Video, Socials, Post/VFX, Other)
- **Budget slider** with live tier label that changes with the value (e.g. ₹50,000 → "Indie Production", higher → bigger-production labels)
- Message, optional timeline, submit button, success and error states
- Alternate path: "Prefer a coffee?" phone link
- Footer microcopy ("Secure connection", location, availability)

4.3 Inner pages

- **Portfolio library:** filters (format, category, brand, year), grid with hover video preview, pagination or infinite scroll, URL-driven filters.
- **Case study:** hero video, brief/challenge/approach/result, credits, gallery, related projects, next/previous project.
- **Service detail:** description, deliverables, process, related work, CTA.
- **Client page:** logo, description, all related projects.
- **About:** story, team, values, timeline, showreel.
- **Production ecosystem:** partner overview, capabilities, equipment/crew, gallery.
- **Vendor registration:** crew/vendor form (name, role, city, rates, portfolio link, file upload).
- **Blog:** list + article template with cover image, author, date, reading time, share buttons, related posts.
- **404 / 500 pages** in brand style.

4.4 Cross-cutting frontend requirements

- Fully responsive (360px to 2560px); mobile-first.

- Video rules: lazy-load embeds (show thumbnail first, load iframe on intersection/click); only one video plays with sound at a time; `playsinline`, muted autoplay; pause when off-screen.
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, keyboard navigation, focus states, `prefers-reduced-motion` support, alt text, captions where possible.
- SEO: unique title/description per page, canonical, Open Graph + Twitter cards (1200×630 image), JSON-LD (Organization, VideoObject, Article, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList).
- Analytics events: CTA clicks, showreel plays, form start/submit, outbound social clicks.

5. Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Choice	Why
Framework	**Next.js (App Router) + TypeScript**	Same approach as the reference; SSR/ISR for SEO, image optimisation
Styling	Tailwind CSS + CSS variables	Fast, consistent theming
Animation	GSAP + ScrollTrigger, Framer Motion, Lenis	Pinned scroll, marquees, smooth scroll
Forms	React Hook Form + Zod	Shared validation client/server
Database	PostgreSQL (Neon or Supabase) + **Prisma**	Relational content, free tiers available
Media storage	Vercel Blob (or Cloudflare R2/S3)	Uploads from admin
Video	YouTube/Vimeo embeds or Mux/Cloudflare Stream	Avoids hosting large video yourself
Email	Resend (or SMTP)	Brief notifications + auto-replies
Auth (admin)	Auth.js (NextAuth) with email/password or Google	Secure dashboard
Spam protection	Cloudflare Turnstile + rate limiting (Upstash Redis)	Protects forms
Hosting	**Vercel**	Zero-config Next.js deploys, preview URLs
Monitoring	Sentry + Vercel Analytics + GA4/Plausible	Errors and traffic

Alternative if you want less code: use a headless CMS (Sanity or Strapi) instead of building the admin yourself. The rest of the stack stays the same.

6. Backend Requirements

6.1 Data model (Prisma entities)

- **Project:** id, slug, title, brandId, category, format (`HORIZONTAL` / `VERTICAL`), videoUrl, thumbnailUrl, description, credits (JSON list of role/name), collaborators, year, featured, order, published, seo fields.

- **Client:** id, slug, name, logoUrl, description, order, published.
- **Service:** id, slug, phase (1–3), title, tagline, description, order.
- **BtsImage:** id, url, alt, order.
- **Post:** id, slug, title, excerpt, content (MDX/rich text), coverUrl, author, tags, publishedAt, status.
- **Faq:** id, group, question, answer, order.
- **Lead:** id, name, email, phone, company, projectType, budget, message, timeline, status (`NEW`, `CONTACTED`, `WON`, `LOST`), source/UTM, createdAt.
- **VendorApplication:** id, name, role, city, rate, portfolioUrl, fileUrl, status.
- **SiteSettings:** contact email/phone, socials, showreel URL, hero video, SEO defaults.
- **AdminUser:** id, email, passwordHash/OAuth id, role.

6.2 API endpoints (Next.js Route Handlers)

Method + path	Purpose	Access
`POST /api/leads`	Submit project brief	Public, rate-limited, Turnstile
`POST /api/vendors`	Submit vendor application	Public, rate-limited
`GET /api/projects`, `/api/projects/[slug]`	List/detail (filters: format, category, brand)	Public (or fetched server-side)
`GET /api/clients`, `/api/services`, `/api/posts`, `/api/faqs`	Content reads	Public
`POST /api/upload`	Signed upload to Blob/R2	Admin
`CRUD /api/admin/projects`, `clients`, `services`, `posts`, `faqs`, `bts`, `settings`	Content management	Admin
`GET/PATCH /api/admin/leads`	View leads, change status, export CSV	Admin
`POST /api/revalidate`	Trigger ISR refresh after edits	Internal/secret

6.3 Contact form flow

1. Client validates with Zod → sends to `/api/leads` with Turnstile token.
2. Server re-validates, verifies token, checks rate limit (e.g. 5/hour/IP), sanitises text.

3. Saves `Lead` to the database **first**, then sends (a) a notification email to you and (b) an auto-reply to the sender. Email failure must never lose the lead; queue and retry.
4. Returns success; UI shows the success state and fires an analytics event.

6.4 Admin dashboard

- Login-protected `/admin` with list/create/edit/delete for every content type, drag-to-reorder, publish/draft toggle, image/video-URL fields, live preview.
- Leads inbox with status filter, notes, CSV export.
- Saving content calls revalidation so changes appear on the site within seconds.

6.5 Security

- Hash passwords (argon2/bcrypt) or use OAuth only; secure, HTTP-only cookies; CSRF protection on mutations.
- Server-side validation on every endpoint; parameterised queries (Prisma).
- Security headers (CSP allowing YouTube/Vimeo and your image host, HSTS, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy).
- Secrets only in environment variables; never in the repo.
- Upload limits: file type/size whitelist.
- Privacy: consent notice on forms, privacy policy, data-deletion process.

7. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Performance:** image optimisation (`next/image`, AVIF/WebP), font subsetting with `font-display: swap`, code-split heavy animation libraries, preload hero poster, avoid layout shift (set aspect ratios), cap total JS on first load.
- **Browser support:** latest 2 versions of Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Edge; iOS Safari 16+.
- **Scalability:** static/ISR pages served from CDN; DB connection pooling.
- **Backups:** daily DB backups with a tested restore.

8. Step-by-Step Implementation Plan

Phase 0: Discovery and design (Week 1)

1. Write your brand brief: name, tagline, tone, colours, fonts, logo.
2. Collect content: showreel, 6+ hero projects (video links + thumbnails), 6+ reels, BTS photos, client logos (with permission), service descriptions, team bios, FAQs.

3. Design in Figma: desktop + mobile for Home, Case Study, Portfolio, Contact. Define the design tokens (colours, type scale, spacing) and motion rules.
4. Approve the design before coding.

Phase 1: Project setup (Week 1–2)

1. Create the repo on GitHub; add `main` (production) and `develop` branches.
2. Run `npx create-next-app@latest` with TypeScript, Tailwind, App Router, ESLint.
3. Install: `gsap`, `framer-motion`, `lenis`, `react-hook-form`, `zod`, `prisma`, `@prisma/client`, `next-auth`, `resend`, `@vercel/blob`.
4. Set up Prettier, ESLint, Husky pre-commit hooks, and a `.env.example` file.
5. Create the folder structure: `app/`, `components/`, `lib/`, `prisma/`, `content/`, `public/`.
6. Add design tokens to `tailwind.config` and global CSS; load fonts via `next/font`.

Phase 2: Frontend build with mock data (Week 2–4)

1. Build global layout: navbar, mobile menu, footer, REC indicator, cursor, smooth scroll.
2. Build reusable components: `VideoCard`, `ProjectSlide`, `Marquee`, `LogoStrip`, `Accordion`, `Button`, `SectionHeader`, `CreditsSlate`.
3. Build home sections one by one in the order of section 4.2 using hard-coded JSON in `/content`.
4. Implement scroll animations (pinned Cinematic Evidence, marquees, swipe deck) and test at 60fps on a mid-range phone.
5. Build the contact brief form UI with chips, budget slider and tier labels.
6. Build inner pages: portfolio, case study, services, about, ecosystem, blog, vendor form, legal, 404.
7. Add SEO metadata, JSON-LD, sitemap, robots.
8. Run accessibility and Lighthouse checks; fix issues.

Phase 3: Backend and database (Week 4–5)

1. Create a Postgres database (Neon/Supabase); set `DATABASE_URL`.
2. Write the Prisma schema from section 6.1; run `prisma migrate dev`; write a seed script that loads your mock content.
3. Replace mock JSON with Prisma queries in server components (use ISR with `revalidate` or tag-based revalidation).
4. Implement `/api/leads` and `/api/vendors` with Zod, Turnstile, rate limiting, DB save, Resend emails.

5. Implement uploads to Blob/R2 for admin use.

Phase 4: Admin CMS (Week 5–6)

1. Configure Auth.js; seed the first admin; protect `/admin` via middleware.
2. Build CRUD screens for projects, clients, services, BTS, posts, FAQs, settings.
3. Add reorder, publish/draft, image upload and revalidation on save.
4. Build the leads inbox with status updates and CSV export.
5. *(Shortcut: use Sanity/Strapi instead and skip steps 1–3.)*

Phase 5: Integration and QA (Week 6–7)

1. Test the full flow: add a project in admin → appears on home, portfolio and case study pages.
2. Submit the brief form → confirm DB row, notification email and auto-reply.
3. Test on real devices (iPhone Safari, Android Chrome), slow 3G throttling, and keyboard-only navigation.
4. Fix performance issues: lazy-load videos, compress images, trim JS.
5. Add Sentry, analytics events, uptime monitor.
6. Write unit tests for validation, integration tests for APIs, and Playwright end-to-end tests for the main journeys.

9. Deployment: Step by Step

1. **Push code** to GitHub (`develop` → PR → `main`).
2. **Create a Vercel project:** Import the repo, framework preset "Next.js". Every pull request automatically gets a preview URL.
3. **Provision services:** production Postgres (Neon/Supabase), Vercel Blob (or R2 bucket), Resend account (verify your sending domain with SPF, DKIM and DMARC DNS records), Upstash Redis, Cloudflare Turnstile keys, Sentry project.
4. **Set environment variables** in Vercel (Production and Preview separately): `DATABASE_URL`, `NEXTAUTH_URL`, `NEXTAUTH_SECRET`, `RESEND_API_KEY`, `BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN`, `TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY`, `NEXT_PUBLIC_TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY`, `UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_URL/TOKEN`, `SENTRY_DSN`, `NEXT_PUBLIC_GA_ID`, `REVALIDATE_SECRET`.
5. **Run migrations** against production: `prisma migrate deploy` (add it to the build command or a release script), then run the seed once.
6. **Deploy to production** by merging to `main`; verify the build log and smoke-test the live Vercel URL.

7. **Connect your custom domain:** add the domain in Vercel, set the DNS records it shows (A record for apex, CNAME for `www`), choose the canonical version and redirect the other. HTTPS is issued automatically.
8. **Set up email DNS:** add Resend's records so notification and auto-reply emails don't land in spam.
9. **Search engines:** submit `sitemap.xml` to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools; verify the domain.
10. **Social previews:** test the OG image with the LinkedIn Post Inspector and a WhatsApp/Twitter share.
11. **Enable monitoring:** Sentry alerts, uptime check on `/` and `/api/health`, Vercel Analytics.
12. **Backups:** enable automatic DB backups and test one restore.
13. **Go-live checklist:** forms deliver email, admin login works, all links resolve, no console errors, Lighthouse targets met, legal pages present, `robots.txt` allows indexing.
14. **Post-launch:** review analytics weekly, fix issues from Sentry, publish blog posts, add new projects monthly.

CI/CD: GitHub Actions runs lint, type-check, unit tests and Playwright on every PR; Vercel deploys only when checks pass. Roll back instantly from the Vercel dashboard if a release breaks.

10. Acceptance Criteria

- All sections in 4.2 and all routes in section 3 exist and match the approved design on mobile and desktop.
- Owner can add/edit/reorder/unpublish a project, client, reel, FAQ and blog post from `/admin` without a deploy.
- A brief submission always results in a saved lead, a notification email and an auto-reply; spam is blocked.
- Performance, accessibility and SEO targets from section 2 are met on production.
- No secrets in the repo; security headers active; backups verified.

11. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Heavy animation hurts mobile performance	Test on mid-range Android early; reduce effects on low-power devices; respect reduced-motion

Risk	Mitigation
Autoplay video blocked or slow	Poster image fallback; lazy-load; muted + `playsinline`
Copying another site's content	Use only your own copy, footage and logos; get client permission for logos
Form spam	Turnstile + rate limiting + honeypot field
Email lands in spam	Verified domain, SPF/DKIM/DMARC, plain-text fallback
Scope creep	Freeze v1 scope at section 4; log extras for v2

12. Suggested Timeline

Week	Deliverable
1	Brand, content collection, Figma designs
2–4	Frontend with mock data
4–5	Database, APIs, email, forms
5–6	Admin CMS
6–7	QA, performance, SEO, monitoring
7	Production launch and handover

A solo developer should plan 7–9 weeks; a small team can compress this to 4–5.